

INTERVIEW BRIEFING · CONFIDENTIAL

Codi Group

Finance Business Partner — Repairs & Maintenance

PREPARED FOR	DATE	SUBJECT	SECTOR
Sandra	28 August 2026	Codi Group Limited, Newport	Welsh social housing, care & support

~25,000	~17,000	3,000+	4,500
homes managed across Wales	people receiving care & support	colleagues	new homes planned over five years

The short version. Codi Group is the merger of Pobl Group and Linc Cymru — Wales' largest housing, care and support provider. The merger completed in April 2024, but the single Codi brand and shared strategy only went live on 1 January 2026. You are interviewing into an organisation that is still becoming one organisation, and into the function — repairs and maintenance — where its largest recurring spend meets its customers.

ORGANISATION · THE MERGER · THE ROLE DECODED · TECHNICAL GROUND · LIKELY QUESTIONS · YOUR QUESTIONS · CHECKLIST

01 The one-minute version

If you remember nothing else, remember this page.

Codi Group is Wales' largest housing, care and support provider. It was created by the merger of **Pobl Group** and **Linc Cymru**, which completed on 1 April 2024, and it adopted the single Codi brand on **1 January 2026** — eight months ago. *Codi* is Welsh for “rise”. It is a not-for-profit registered social landlord, so every surplus is reinvested.

You are interviewing into an organisation that is **still becoming one organisation**. That single fact should shape most of your answers.

Legal entity	Codi Group Limited — a registered society (Companies House reference IP29682R), not a limited company. Registered at Exchange House, High Street, Newport.
Formed	Pobl Group / Linc Cymru merger completed 1 April 2024; Linc became a subsidiary of Pobl Group. Codi name announced June 2025, adopted 1 January 2026.
What it does	Three legs: homes (social and affordable rent, shared ownership and sale), care and support (supported housing, extra care, older people, homelessness, learning disability, mental health), and place-making including commercial space for local businesses.
Leadership	Group Chief Executive Scott Sanders ; Chair Julia Cherrett (both carried over from Pobl Group).
Charitable arm	Codi Trust — improving quality of life in the communities where Codi operates.
Regulator	Welsh Government Housing Regulation. In the interim post-merger judgement of July 2024, the group was rated Green for both Governance & Tenant Services and Financial Viability — the highest available. That is a genuine strength; say so.
Stated ambition	More than 4,500 new homes over five years and a contribution of roughly £1bn to the Welsh economy over the same period.
Purpose language	“Help people live well, feel supported and achieve their full potential.” “Using collective strength to shape better futures for people and places in a sustainable, long-term way.”

What's in this brief

- **02 · The organisation** — structure, geography, group entities, culture cues
- **03 · The merger** — why it is the defining context for a finance role right now
- **04 · The role decoded** — the advert line by line, and what “good” looks like
- **05 · Technical ground** — repairs finance, capitalisation, WHQS 2023, the metrics
- **06 · Likely questions** — and how to answer them
- **07 · Your questions & practicalities** — what to ask, and what the process looks like
- **08 · Before you go** — checklist, a note on sourcing, and sources

02 The organisation

A large, multi-entity group with a social purpose and a commercial edge.

The three things Codi actually does

Homes. Around 25,000 across Wales — social rent, affordable rent, shared ownership and outright sale, plus a development pipeline. The heartland is South Wales: Newport, Cardiff and Swansea, spanning 14 or more local authority areas.

Care and support. Roughly 17,000 people supported. This is unusually large for a housing association and is a defining feature of the group — it means significant local-authority and health-board contract income, staff-cost-heavy P&Ls, and commissioning risk that a pure landlord would not carry.

Places. Regeneration and commercial space for local businesses, plus the charitable work of Codi Trust.

Group structure — worth understanding before you walk in

The legacy Pobl group operated through a family of subsidiaries, and that architecture largely carries into Codi:

- **Pobl Homes and Communities Ltd** — the principal registered social landlord (13,114 homes across 14 local authority areas at FY24). Linc Cymru Housing Association was slated to transfer its engagements into this entity during 2025.
- **Pobl Development Ltd** — development and construction (turnover £65.7m in FY24, up from £48.2m).
- **Pobl Living Ltd** — market-facing housing activity (surplus before tax £1.35m in FY25).
- **Pobl Care and Support Ltd** — care and support delivery.
- **Arloes Ltd** and **Pobl Trust** — further trading and charitable vehicles.

Why this matters to you

A multi-entity group means consolidation, intra-group recharges and allocations, partial-exemption VAT, and charitable versus non-charitable subsidiaries with different tax treatments. Repairs and maintenance spend cuts across several of these entities. If you can show you have worked in a group structure — not just a single ledger — say it early and say it plainly.

Culture cues to mirror

Codi's own language is consistent and worth borrowing: *person-centred; responsive, proactive and adaptable to individual needs; staying connected to communities; collective strength; long-term and sustainable*. The Welsh identity is deliberate and prominent — the name was chosen to signal it.

The practical read: they want a finance person who can hold two ideas at once — that money is tight and must be controlled, *and* that the point of the money is a person in a home. Answers that are purely cost-reduction will land badly. Answers that are purely warm will land worse.

One line to have ready

“Every pound I help you save on a repair isn't a saving — it's a pound that goes into another home. That's the thing I like about finance in a not-for-profit: the trade-off is visible.”

03 The merger, and why it decides this interview

The rebrand is eight months old. The integration is not finished. That is your opening.

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENED
1 Apr 2024	Merger completes. Linc Cymru (~5,500 homes) becomes a subsidiary of Pobl Group (~18,000 homes). Combined group: 23,000+ homes, 3,000+ colleagues.
Jul 2024	Welsh Government publishes an interim regulatory judgement following the merger — Green / Green .
2025	Legal consolidation via transfer of engagements; new name Codi Group announced in June.
1 Jan 2026	Single Codi brand and shared strategy go live.
Now	Systems, policies, data and culture still converging. Hiring senior finance business partners.

Five consequences a finance business partner should be able to name

1. There are two of everything

Two charts of accounts, two ledgers, two capitalisation policies, two stock-condition datasets, two repairs systems, two sets of contractor frameworks and schedules of rates. Harmonising these is real, unglamorous work. When the advert says “contribute to major transformation projects”, this is almost certainly a large part of what it means.

2. Someone has to prove the merger worked

Mergers are justified to the board, the regulator and lenders on stated benefits — efficiency, procurement scale, capacity to develop. Tracking whether those benefits actually land is a business partnering job, and it is the kind of thing organisations often under-resource. Offering to own it is a strong, credible pitch.

3. Comparisons are not yet like-for-like

Legacy Linc and legacy Pobl stock differ in age, archetype, construction and WHQS position. A cost-per-property comparison across the combined estate is misleading until it is normalised for stock profile. Saying this out loud demonstrates exactly the analytical scepticism they are hiring for — and it is a safe observation, because it is true of every merged landlord.

4. Treasury and covenants are now group-scale

A bigger consolidated loan book, security charging across a combined asset base, and interest cover and gearing covenants tested at group level. Repairs classification feeds straight into this — see section 05.

5. “One team” is still being built

Business partnering is largely relationship work, and in a post-merger organisation you will be partnering people who came from two different cultures and may still identify with them. Prepare a story about building trust with a team that had reason not to trust finance.

The sentence that shows you did the work

“You completed the merger in 2024 but only went live with one brand and one strategy in January. My assumption is that finance is still running a lot of reconciliation between two legacy sets of data — and that the value of this role in year one is getting repairs reporting onto a single, trusted basis so the leadership team is arguing about decisions rather than about whose number is right.”

04 The role, decoded

What the advert says, and what it is really asking for.

Title	Finance Business Partner — Repairs & Maintenance
Salary	£64,891
Terms	Permanent, full time, 37 hours per week
Location	Hybrid, with office bases in Cardiff, Newport or Swansea
Flexibility	Flexible working, Monday to Friday, with the option of a compressed nine-day fortnight
Scope	Influencing investment across more than 25,000 homes in South Wales
Talent contact	group.talent@codigroup.co.uk · 0300 373 5262

The advert, line by line

“ A strategic and collaborative role, working closely with senior leaders to help them understand financial performance”

They want translation, not reporting. The distinction they are testing is whether you send a pack or hold a conversation. Every example you give should end with a decision that changed.

“ Budget setting, forecasting, financial reporting and performance analysis”

The core cycle, and the most likely source of a technical question. Be ready to describe how you build a repairs budget from the bottom up, and how you improved forecast accuracy somewhere.

“ Leading conversations around risks, opportunities and continuous improvement”

Leading is the operative word. They want constructive challenge, not a service desk. Have an example where you told an operational director something they did not want to hear, and kept the relationship.

“ Partnering teams managing significant investment across homes, ensuring financial information is accurate, meaningful and supports effective decision-making”

This is asset management, planned works and major repairs — large capital numbers with long lead times and real classification judgement. “Meaningful” signals that the current reporting probably is not.

“ Support the development of reporting tools and drive improvements in financial processes”

Self-serve dashboards, almost certainly Power BI. You do not need to be a developer, but you should be able to say what you would put on a one-page dashboard for a repairs director, and why.

“ Contribute to major transformation projects across the Repairs & Maintenance service”

Merger integration, and quite possibly a review of the repairs operating model itself. Ask about this — see section 07.

“ Experience of contract, project or programme management within a social housing environment would be valuable, as would an understanding of repairs and maintenance financial reporting”

These are *desirable*, not essential — sector experience is a differentiator, not a gate. If you have it, lead with it. If not, close the gap explicitly (see page 7).

What “good” looks like in this seat

A director who stops asking finance for numbers because they trust the dashboard; a forecast that stops moving 10% between months; a capitalisation policy applied the same way in Swansea and Newport.

05 Technical ground to be solid on

The five areas where a repairs finance business partner earns credibility in the first ten minutes.

A. Capital versus revenue — the single biggest judgement

Under FRS 102 and the Housing SORP, spend on housing properties is capitalised only where it enhances economic benefits beyond the asset's originally assessed standard of performance, or where it replaces an identified component. Everything else is revenue.

Component accounting is the mechanism: kitchens, bathrooms, roofs, windows, boilers, rewires and external works are each held with their own useful life and depreciated separately. When a component is replaced, the residual carrying value of the old component must be **derecognised** — a charge to surplus that people routinely forget when they build a major-works business case.

Why this is the question that matters. Where you draw the capital/revenue line moves operating surplus, moves EBITDA-MRI, and therefore moves interest cover covenant headroom. In a group that has just merged two organisations with two legacy capitalisation policies, inconsistent application is a live risk — and flagging it is one of the most impressive things you can do in the room.

B. Know the cost categories, and never conflate them

- **Responsive / reactive repairs** — demand-led, volatile, hardest to forecast.
- **Cyclical maintenance** — servicing, external decoration; predictable, programme-driven.
- **Planned and major works** — component replacement; largely capital.
- **Voids** — turnaround works; sits at the intersection of repairs cost and rental income loss.
- **Compliance** — gas, electrical, fire, asbestos, legionella and lifts. Non-negotiable spend; a budget pressure you manage around, never into.
- **Damp, mould and disrepair** — a rising sector-wide cost with legal and reputational tails.

C. Delivery model economics

Repairs are delivered in-house (a direct labour organisation), by contractors, or by a mix — and the finance questions differ sharply. In-house: recharge rates, overhead absorption, productivity per operative, van stock and materials. Contracted: schedule of rates versus price-per-property, contract variations, retention. **Find out which model Codi uses — it is a good question to ask, and the answer reshapes the job.**

05 Technical ground / continued

The policy backdrop every Welsh landlord is working against, and the numbers that prove you speak the language.

D. The Welsh policy frame

- **WHQS 2023** — the new Welsh Housing Quality Standard, adding decarbonisation and water-efficiency targets on a phased compliance timetable. Sector-wide, the energy and decarbonisation elements are seen as the hardest part, with ambition running ahead of capacity and funding certainty. Expect this to dominate the investment programme.
- **Rent policy** — annual uplifts are set and capped by Welsh Government. Income is largely exogenous, so *cost control is where the lever is*. This is the sharpest difference from a commercial finance role and worth naming.
- **The core tension** — investment in existing stock (WHQS, decarbonisation, safety) competes directly with new development against Welsh Government targets. Every Welsh landlord is arguing about this allocation. Have a view.
- **Regulation** — Welsh Government Housing Regulation publishes judgements on Governance & Tenant Services and on Financial Viability. Codi holds Green on both.

E. Metrics to have on the tip of your tongue

- Cost per property — responsive, planned, total
- Percentage of repairs spend capitalised
- Forecast accuracy and variance to budget
- Jobs per operative per day
- First-time fix rate; average days to complete
- Void turnaround time and cost; rent loss
- Compliance percentage across the big six
- EBITDA-MRI interest cover; gearing

If you only land one technical point, land this one

“In repairs, the number that matters is not the total — it's the split between volume and unit cost, and the split between capital and revenue. The first tells you whether you have a demand problem or a price problem. The second tells you what it does to your covenants. Most repairs reporting I've seen gives you neither.”

Honest positioning if you are new to social housing

Do not pretend. Say instead: *“I haven't worked in social housing, but I've partnered an operational, contract-heavy budget where volume was demand-led and price was contracted — the mechanics are the same. What I'd need to learn quickly is the regulatory frame: WHQS 2023, the rent settlement and how the capitalisation policy interacts with your covenants. I've made a start.”* Then prove the start. Competence plus candour beats borrowed jargon, and panels can always tell the difference.

06 Likely questions, and how to answer

Expect a competency-led panel. Have six STAR stories ready — every one should end in a decision or a number that moved.

Business partnering and behaviour

1. Why Codi, and why now?

Merger plus scale plus purpose. Repairs is where the largest recurring spend and the customer experience meet — say that is why the role appeals rather than saying the salary or the location does.

2. Tell us about a time you influenced a senior non-finance leader to change a decision.

The flagship story. Be specific about the resistance, what evidence shifted it, and what it saved or avoided.

3. Describe a time you delivered an unwelcome financial message. How did you keep the relationship?

They are testing whether “leading conversations around risks” means anything to you. Show early warning, not a late ambush.

4. How do you build credibility with an operational team that sees finance as a blocker?

Go and watch the work. Say you would spend time with repairs supervisors and on site before changing a single report — in this sector that answer is always right, and it is true.

Technical

5. Walk us through how you would build the repairs and maintenance budget from scratch.

Volume × unit cost, built from stock-condition data and historic demand; separate the categories in section 05B; overlay the compliance programme as fixed; layer inflation on labour and materials distinctly; hold a contingency for damp and disrepair; then sense-check top-down on cost per property.

6. A kitchen replacement — capital or revenue?

Component replacement, so capitalise the new component, derecognise the carrying value of the old, and depreciate over the component life. But a like-for-like repair to part of a kitchen is revenue. Name the covenant consequence and you have answered it better than most.

7. Repairs spend is significantly over budget at month six. What do you do?

Structure the answer: first, is it real — accruals, phasing, coding? Then decompose into volume, price and mix. Then, is it one scheme or systemic? Then forecast the full-year position, identify mitigations with the budget holder, and escalate early with options rather than with a problem.

8. What would you put on a one-page dashboard for the Repairs Director?

Spend against budget by category, full-year forecast with a movement bridge, cost per property, volume and unit-cost split, compliance position, and two or three operational drivers such as first-time fix. One page, no more than eight numbers, each with an owner.

The STAR discipline

Situation and Task in two sentences, Action in five, Result in one — with a number in it. Panels forgive a thin Situation. They never forgive a missing Result.

06 Likely questions / continued

Judgement questions. There is rarely a right answer — they are watching how you reason.

Sector and commercial judgement

9. How should we balance investment in existing homes against building new ones?

Do not pick a side. Existing-stock obligations under WHQS 2023 and safety are largely non-discretionary; development is discretionary and grant-dependent. The honest answer is that the existing stock sets the floor, and the development programme flexes against covenant headroom and grant availability.

10. What are the biggest financial risks facing Welsh housing associations right now?

Decarbonisation and WHQS costs against uncertain long-term funding; capped rents against above-inflation build and repair cost increases; borrowing costs; skills and contractor capacity; and rising damp, mould and disrepair liabilities.

11. What does value for money mean in repairs?

Not lowest cost. Cost per outcome — right first time, fewer recalls, fewer disrepair claims, and planned work displacing expensive reactive work.

Change and integration

12. How would you approach harmonising two different sets of financial processes?

Map both, find where they genuinely differ rather than where they are merely described differently, agree a single policy with the people who have to apply it, then sequence: reporting basis first, systems second. Expect this question. It is the one most specific to Codi.

13. Where do you see yourself adding most value in the first six months?

A closing-stretch favourite. Answer in three: understand the operation by being in it; get one trusted set of repairs numbers; then use that to reopen one decision that is currently being made on instinct.

Two traps to avoid

Sounding like an auditor. This is a partnering role. If every answer is about control, accuracy and compliance, they will hear a management accountant. Balance each control point with a decision you helped someone make.

Being glib about the social purpose. Do not open with how much the mission moves you — it reads as rehearsed. Let it show through in how you talk about the trade-offs instead. In a not-for-profit, demonstrated understanding beats declared passion.

07 Your questions, and the practicalities

Ask three or four. Specific questions are the cheapest credibility available.

Strong questions to ask them

- **How far through the integration of the two legacy finance and repairs systems are you, and where does this role pick that up?** Signals you understand the real job.
- **Is repairs delivered in-house, through contractors, or a mix — and is that model under review?** Reshapes the role, and shows you know it does.
- **What does the WHQS 2023 compliance trajectory look like across the combined stock, and how is that programme funded?** Sector fluency in one sentence.
- **How does the business plan balance the 4,500-home development ambition against existing-stock investment?** A board-level question, asked politely.
- **Who are my business partners day to day, and how do they get their numbers today?** Practical, and tells you how much of the job is rebuilding trust.
- **What would you want me to have fixed by the end of the first 90 days?** Always ask this.
- **What has changed for colleagues since the Codi brand went live in January?** Warm, current, and tells you a lot.

Process and practicalities

Reported format	On employee review sites, the legacy Pobl process is described as a panel of two managers asking set, role-related questions, sometimes with verbal reasoning or attention-to-detail tests and a video stage, running around two weeks end to end. <i>Indicative only — confirm with the recruiter.</i>
Employee sentiment	Around 3.8 out of 5 on anonymous review sites, with roughly 76% saying they would recommend the organisation. Hybrid working and culture are cited positively; pay progression and personal development are the recurring criticisms, and there are isolated complaints about team culture. Anonymous and unverified — useful as things to probe, not as facts to repeat.
Worth confirming	Which entity and directorate the role sits in; who it reports to; whether a technical or presentation stage is included; and the interview panel's names.

On the salary

£64,891 is a single stated figure rather than a band, which usually signals a fixed point on a graded pay structure with limited room to negotiate. Treat the number as given, and put your energy into confirming the package around it — pension contribution rates, annual leave, the nine-day fortnight, and how progression works. If pay is the sticking point, the honest question is about the grade and its review cycle, not about this offer.

How to close

Ask for the decision timeline, then leave them with one sentence that ties your case to their problem — not a summary of your CV. Something like: *“What I’d want to be judged on here is whether, a year from now, your repairs leadership team is making decisions off one set of numbers they trust — because from the outside, that looks like the thing that unlocks everything else.”*

Then stop talking. Panels remember the last thing you said far more than the fourth thing.

08 Before you go

An hour of this is worth more than a day of rereading the brief.

Checklist

- ☐ Read the latest Codi / Pobl Group annual report and consolidated financial statements. Note turnover, operating surplus, interest cover, gearing, and the split of repairs spend between capital and revenue.
- ☐ Read the Welsh Government interim regulatory judgement for Pobl Group (July 2024).
- ☐ Skim the WHQS 2023 overview on gov.wales — twenty minutes is enough.
- ☐ Look up the panel on LinkedIn; check whether they came from legacy Pobl or legacy Linc.
- ☐ Write out six STAR stories. At least two must involve influencing an operational leader.
- ☐ Prepare a one-sentence answer to “why not a commercial finance role?”

A note on sourcing, and one gap

This brief was compiled on 28 August 2026 from public news coverage of the merger and rebrand, published job advertisements, Companies House and Welsh Government regulator references, and employee review sites. **codigroup.co.uk and gov.wales were not directly reachable from the machine this was built on**, so the figures here are as reported by third parties rather than read from source documents.

The one material gap is **Codi's consolidated group turnover and surplus**, which could not be retrieved — only subsidiary-level figures were available. The annual report is public; pull the headline numbers from it before the interview and do not quote a group figure you have not seen.

Sources

- Inside Housing — “Largest Welsh housing association officially rebrands as Codi following merger”; “Welsh landlords reveal rebrand after merger”
- Housing Today — “Linc and Pobl rebrand as Codi following merger”; “Linc Cymru and Pobl Group pick new name for merged group”
- Wales 247 — “Wales' largest housing provider rebrands as Codi Group”; Swansea Bay News; News from Wales; Insider Media (Wales)
- Welsh Housing Quarterly (WHQ) — “Pobl and Linc complete merger”; “Pobl and Linc to become Codi Group”
- GOV.WALES — Pobl Group interim regulatory judgement 2024; Welsh Housing Quality Standard overview
- Companies House — CODI GROUP LIMITED (IP29682R)
- Pobl Group and subsidiary annual reports and financial statements, FY24 and FY25
- Codi Group job advertisement, Finance Business Partner — Repairs & Maintenance (via BeBee, Indeed, Glassdoor)
- Glassdoor and Indeed employee reviews and reported interview experiences, Codi Group / Pobl Group